

Frequently Asked Questions

What could delay my refund from being paid to me?

When you submit your tax return, the following may delay...

Can I see my refund amount and payment date or the payment due date of the amount owed by me to SARS on eFiling?

Yes, you can see both on eFiling. The refund amount...

Why have I been charged an Administrative Penalty?

Administrative penalties may be imposed by SARS due to non-compliance...

How long does the Complaints process take?

When you lodge a complaint, SARS will issue an acknowledgement...

How to amend my ITR12?

To revise or amend an assessment; process the Request for...

How to access my ITR12 on eFiling?

After successful login to eFiling, proceed as follows: • Click...

Both my eFiling security contact details have changed (email and cellphone number) – how do I get the One Time Pin(OTP) ?

If both your security contact details have changed i.e. you...

SARS has paid my refund into an old bank account, what now?

The onus is on the taxpayer to ensure SARS has...

I've been auto assessed but need to update my Banking Details, how can I stop the refund from being paid into the wrong account?
SARS will verify the details of the bank account with...

What is the difference between the ITA34 and the SOA?
The differences are: Notice of Assessment (ITA34) Statement of account...

If I'm getting a refund, when does the 72 hours start?
The 72 hours start from the time the assessment has...

Why is a payment date showing when I'm getting a refund?
The payment due date is a standard field on the...

What does a minus amount mean on my Notice of Assessment (ITA34)?
A negative amount indicates that a refund is due to...

Can the secondary spouse object to the 'Married in Community Spousal Assessment' ?
Yes, such assessments will be subject to objection and appeal,...

Will SARS inform the primary spouse?
Yes, SARS must inform the primary spouse that because of...

Could this have a destabilising effect on families where the taxpayer is Married in Community of Property?
SARS is simply applying tax laws which follows matrimonial laws,...

What should I do if I want to exclude my spouse from communal estate due to a legal contract?

You may access your return where the Investment income section...

What should I do if I am divorced from my spouse?

You may request for correction and amend your marital status...

What should I do if I am separated from my spouse?

You may inform SARS of the separation by completing RRA01...

Where do the amounts found on my return come from?

SARS has identified you as married in community of property...

What does POPI act say about the communication around the 'Married in Community Spousal Assessment' ?

In compliance with POPI Act, SARS may notify the other...

What are the tax implications if I am married in community of property?

If you are married in community of property, you are...

I don't see my IRP5 on my return?

If you have requested your IRP5 or IT3(a) certificate from...

How do I request an ITR12 return on eFiling?

Follow the steps below to request an Income Tax return:...

What must I do if my IRP5/IT3(a) information for my lump sum is not on my Income Tax Return (ITR12)?
If the 'Transaction Year' and the 'Year of assessment' differs...

What are S11F annual allowable deductions?
You are entitled to a deduction, under section 11F, of...

How long is my certificate of residence valid for?
A certificate of residence is only valid for a period...

What are the requirement for a certificate of residence to be issued to me?
The following are requirements for a certificate of residence: :-...

How do I apply for a certificate of residence?
Where the South African resident rendered services or received income...

Do I have to be registered for Income tax to obtain a certificate of residence?
A person or partner in partnership (partner) must be registered...

How do I know that I fall within the definition of a resident?
a) The definition of resident refers to a natural person...

I am currently employed by an overseas company who requires confirmation of my South African residency how do I obtain this?
The country where a SA resident rendered services or received...

I pay contributions to a medical scheme but the medical tax certificate is not in my name and I have been selected for audit. Which supporting documents must I submit?

You need to submit an affidavit stating that the main...

How do I register on the SARS app or SARS MobiApp?

Download our enhanced SARS MobiApp from the Google Play Store...

What is meant by a 'spot rate'?

The term 'spot rate' means the appropriate quoted exchange rate...

How will SARS treat cryptocurrencies?

SARS will apply general tax principles and tax the income...

Can I update the SARS eFiling App for free?

No, the service data charges will apply for updates.

Can I download the SARS eFiling App for free?

Yes.

On the SARS eFiling App will you have the option to work off-line?

The SARS eFiling App has offline capability.

Where can one register for eFiling?

Register on the SARS eFiling App downloadable from App stores...

How long is a tax directive valid for?
A tax directive is valid only for the tax year...

Do I need to enable fingerprints to complete my income tax form on the eFiling app?
If your device has biometrics capabilities, you may select to...

I want to upload supporting documents requested by SARS, how do I do that on the mobile app?
Review the letter sent by SARS on the ITR12workpage; select...

Can a taxpayer withdraw a Notice of Objection?
A taxpayer can withdraw a Notice of Objection. The request...

Can a registration for income tax be backdated?
The registration for income tax may be backdated to the...

What does IT48 stand for?
Income from local Farming Operations.

What is a fringe benefit?
Fringe benefits usually refer to non-cash benefits granted to employees,...

What does SARS mean by annual payments?
These are examples of annual payments: the Annual bonus, Incentive...

Does SARS accept the financial statements in foreign currency for the foreign income received?
Although financial statements drawn up in another currency are acceptable...

Do I use foreign currency to declare foreign income?
All foreign income must be declared in South African currency.

I donated some money to my child who is a minor, do I declare?
You are liable for tax on any income received by/accrued...

How do I declare investment income on my return if I am married in community of property?
The total amount of your investment income must be declared...

How does SARS treat insolvent taxpayers?
Please explain the different tax numbers used for an insolvency...

I am not a South African resident and I work in South Africa for a foreign government, what are the tax implications?
The remuneration paid to any domestic or private servants of...

I work for a foreign government in South Africa, what are the tax implications?
In terms of Section 10(1)(c)(iii) any remuneration paid to any...

In the past I was employed outside South Africa, in another country, and I received pension. Do I pay tax on this amount?
Any pension received or accrued to any resident from a...

I received pension outside South Africa, do I pay tax on this amount?
Pensions received by or accrued to a resident under the...

I worked outside South Africa, in another country, for a South African company, how do I treat my remuneration/income?
Remuneration as a result of services rendered for an employer...

How is the income received by me treated if I am married in community of property to my spouse?
Income received by (or accrued to) a taxpayer (other than...

For how long am I expected to keep the supporting documents?
You are required to keep all supporting documents for a...

How do married couples submit the supporting documents?
If you are married in community of property, the certificates...

Who can submit the tax return on my behalf?
A tax practitioner that is registered with a recognised controlling...

Where on can I see the amount I must pay to SARS on eFiling?
The amount payable by you will be detailed on the...

Where can I find information to help me fill in an income tax form correctly?
For information on how to fill in your Income Tax...

I received an inheritance, must I declare it to SARS?

Yes you will need to declare the amount received.

How do I calculate my income tax liability using the tax calculator on eFiling?

Select the 'Tax Calculator' after completing your income tax return.

Do I need to submit supporting documents every time I submit my income tax form?

Supporting documents must only be submitted to SARS when requested...

How do I submit supporting document with my income tax form?

Supporting documents must not be submitted with an income tax...

I pressed by mistake the manual submit button on eFiling. How do I correct this?

Use the 'Request for Correction' button.

Who provides me with a unique identifier?

SARS will allocate a new unique identifier number.

What is a unique identifier?

A unique identifier is a number allocated to each property,...

What would travel between home and work be classified as?

Travelling between home and work is private travelling, it is...

How many capital gain transactions will I be able to complete on the income tax form?
You may capture a maximum of ten transactions on an...

I sold my house, which amount must I declare on the income tax form?
All capital gain transactions must be declared on the income...

I have received dividend from a source outside of South Africa, how do I declare this amount on the income tax form?
Complete the amount for foreign dividends next to source code...

Where will I complete foreign tax paid on the income tax form?
Complete the gross amount for foreign tax paid next to...

How do I convert income measured in a foreign currency to Rands?
It can be converted by using either: The spot rate;...

Does the SARS interest get exempted from income?
Yes, the limitation for interest exemption will be proportioned.

Should I declare SARS interest?
Yes, use source code 4237

Do I need to submit an income tax form if I only earned interest income?
If the amount received is in excess of the prescribed...

I receive interest income, do I need to declare it on the income tax form?

Yes, interest income forms part of taxable income.

I only received a monthly annuity, do I need to submit a tax form?

Yes, you must submit an income tax return.

Can I claim for more than one Retirement Annuity?

Yes, you can claim for more than one retirement annuity....

Which amount do I capture for medical scheme contributions made by my employer?

Medical scheme contributions that were paid by the employer will...

I made medical contribution on behalf of my mother, how do I claim that payment (contributions)?

The amount must be declared next to code 4005.

The tax certificate information on the income tax form differs to the one I received from my employer. How do I fix this?

Refresh the tax certificate data by clicking the "Refresh" button...

What happens if my employer does not send SARS my tax certificate on time?

SARS cannot provide you with a populated return nor process...

My tax certificate is blank on the income tax form, what can I do?

Click the 'Refresh IRP 5 data' button, the information that...

What can I do if the information on the tax certificate is incorrect?

You will have to request a reprint of the tax...

Can SARS assist with deletion of information captured on a tax certificate?

SARS cannot amend or delete any information captured by the...

What is the purpose of the “Refresh Data” tab?

By selecting the “Refresh Data” tab you make it possible...

Will SARS accept photocopies of an income tax form?

SARS will not accept any photocopies or self-printed forms.

Can I update my address on an income tax form?

Yes, the address can be updated on an income tax...

Will I be able to see a preview of my assessment before I submit my income tax form to SARS?

Yes, by selecting the tax calculator you can view an...

Is the assessment result received via the tax calculator one hundred percent correct?

The tax calculator result is merely an estimate of what...

Can I apply for an extension to submit my income tax form at a later stage?

No extensions for late submission will be allowed.

I want to reduce the number of tax certificates supplied to SARS, how do I do that on the income tax form?
The number of tax certificates filled in on the form...

I worked for seven employers, SARS can only pick up certificates from two employers. How do I make sure SARS has all certificates on my income tax form?
You can indicate the correct number of tax certificates you...

The information sent to SARS by my employer is incorrect on the tax certificate, how can I correct this with SARS?
If any of the information on the tax certificate is...

How many tax certificates can I capture on the income tax form?
A maximum of fifteen tax certificates can be captured on...

My bank details have changed, will SARS update the new details I captured on the income tax form?
If you change your banking details on the income tax...

How will SARS pay me my refund if they do not have my bank details on their records?
If SARS does not have valid banking details and has...

What happens if I do not have a local bank account?
Select the statement 'I declare that I have no South...

I do not have a bank account, I use my spouse's bank account. What must I complete on the income tax form?

Select the statement 'I use a South African Bank Account...

Where will I find the country code for South Africa on an income tax form?
You can select 'ZAF' from the drop down list provided.

I am unable to access my emails, how will SARS notify me of my assessment result?
A registered eFiler can view Notice of Assessments from their...

Is it a must to provide SARS with my partner's (spouse) details on an income tax form?
If you are 'married in community of property' certain details,...

How can I update my ID number or Passport Number?
Visit the nearest SARS branch office.

Can I change my ID number or Passport number on the income tax form?
No, you will have to visit a SARS branch office to...

Why am I receiving a warning message regarding banking details when I open my Income tax form?
The warning message indicates that any changes to banking details...

How many rental activities can I capture on the income tax form?
A maximum of 20 rental activities can be declared.

Can I submit last years return on eFiling?

Yes, you will be able to submit for previous years...

How do I complete my Income tax form on eFiling?
Open your income tax return by clicking on income tax...

I am now registered on eFiling. Will I be able to complete and submit a tax return form before SARS opens the filing season?
Only in exceptional cases, such as emigrating, can a taxpayer...

I worked overseas and I only have rental income to declare to SARS. Must I submit an income tax form for this year?
Yes you will be required to submit an income tax...

What if my form already shows that I ceased to be a South African resident?
If you ceased to be a resident and that information...

If the Tax Practitioner is submitting my income tax form how do I inform SARS?
The Tax Practitioner submitting your income tax form will answer...

Can an income tax form be created for me without having to complete the questions on the first page?
The income tax return will be customised according to answers...

Can SARS branch help me with my login details for eFiling?
Yes you can be assisted at a SARS branch.

Can I request for my eFiling login details from the SARS contact centre?

Yes, a contact centre staff can assist you to obtain...

Once I am successfully registered on eFiling, will I have to send anything to SARS to activate eFiling?
No you will not be required to do anything further.

I don't have a South African ID number. Can I register on eFiling?
You can use your passport number if you don't have...

Can I choose not to select a default Primary user?
No. All users will have to select a default primary...

What is a default Primary User?
A Primary User is a default username that is selected...

Where do I find SARS payment or bank details to pay my Personal Income Tax via EFT or at a bank branch?
If you owe money to SARS, the Payment Advice on...

By when should I pay SARS if I owe money on my Return?
If your assessment shows that you owe tax to SARS,...

Where do I find my Statement of Account (ITSA) to see my outstanding balance?
Your Statement of Account (ITSA) shows the overall balance on...

Where do I find my Notice of Assessment (ITA34) to see if I owe SARS money?

Your Notice of Assessment (ITA34) shows if you owe SARS...

I received more than fifteen IRP5 certificates for the year of assessment?
The return caters for a maximum of fifteen IRP5 certificates...

Can I edit the fields on my IRP5?
Check your IRP5 and verify if all the information is...

What is the impact of Section 11(k) on me as a taxpayer?
Any contribution by an employer to a retirement fund for...

What is remuneration?
Remuneration means any amount of income which is paid or...

Which supporting documents must the taxpayer attach when lodging the objection for excess fund contributions?
Any supporting documents to support the excess fund contributions e.g....

Will non-residents be required to declare interest subject to withholding tax on their income tax returns?
Under normal circumstances they will not have to since they...

I will be starting to work overseas, but have never worked in South Africa nor registered for tax. Will I need to register and pay tax while working overseas?
South Africa has a residence-based tax system, which means residents...

What does “manual intervention” mean when submitting my Income Tax Return (ITR12)?

Manual intervention means that human intervention is needed to finalise...

What must I do if my IRP5/IT3(a) information is not on my Income Tax Return (ITR12)?

The ITR12 has been generated and contains the latest information...

Why am I not able to change my identity number/passport number/passport country and passport issue date on my ITR12?

SARS checks your Date Of Birth, ID number and Passport...

Can I claim professional subscription fees as a chartered accountant?

A person who earns remuneration income (which is not derived...

If the populated information is incorrect on my ITR12 return, how do I correct this?

Check your IRP5 and verify if all the information is...

Must I submit a return if I have multiple IRP5's?

Yes, if you have more than one source of remuneration,...

Where can I find information to help me fill in my ITR12 correctly?

For information on how to fill in your ITR12 correctly: See...

How is interest paid to a non-resident from a South African source taxed?

As from 1 March 2015 interest from a South African...

Can a registration for income tax be backdated?

Yes

What are penalties for not submitting my income tax return?

The penalties for not submitting a tax return are set...

What is the foreign tax credit limit for individuals?

The rebate is limited to the foreign tax payable and...

What is remuneration for tax purposes?

Remuneration is any amount of income which is paid/payable to...

Why must I register for Income Tax?

If your earnings for a given tax year are above...